



Week 01

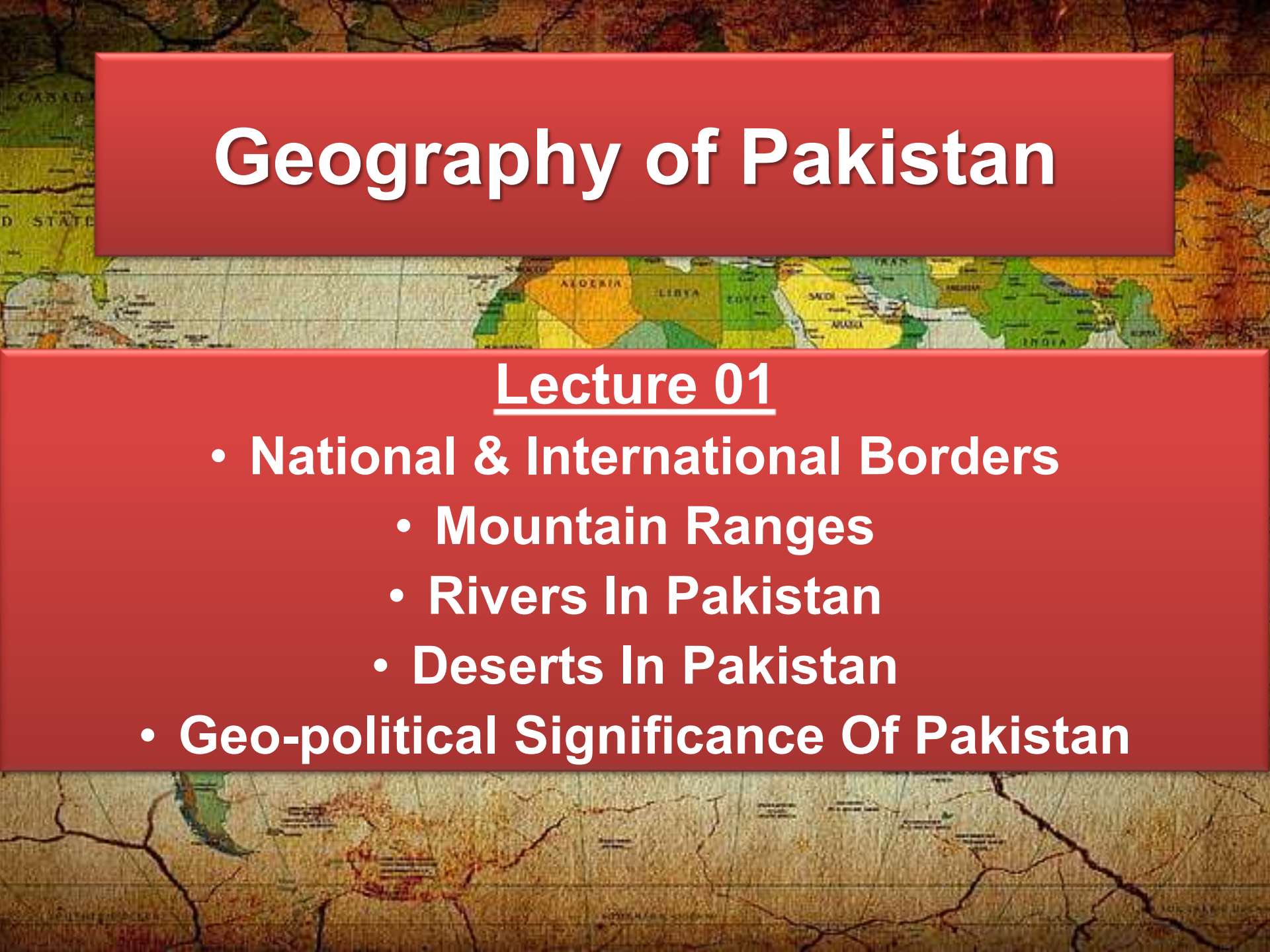
Lecture 01

ICE BREAKER

Course Instructor: Ms. Khushboo Farid

Course Title: Pakistan Studies

Course Code: SS-1015

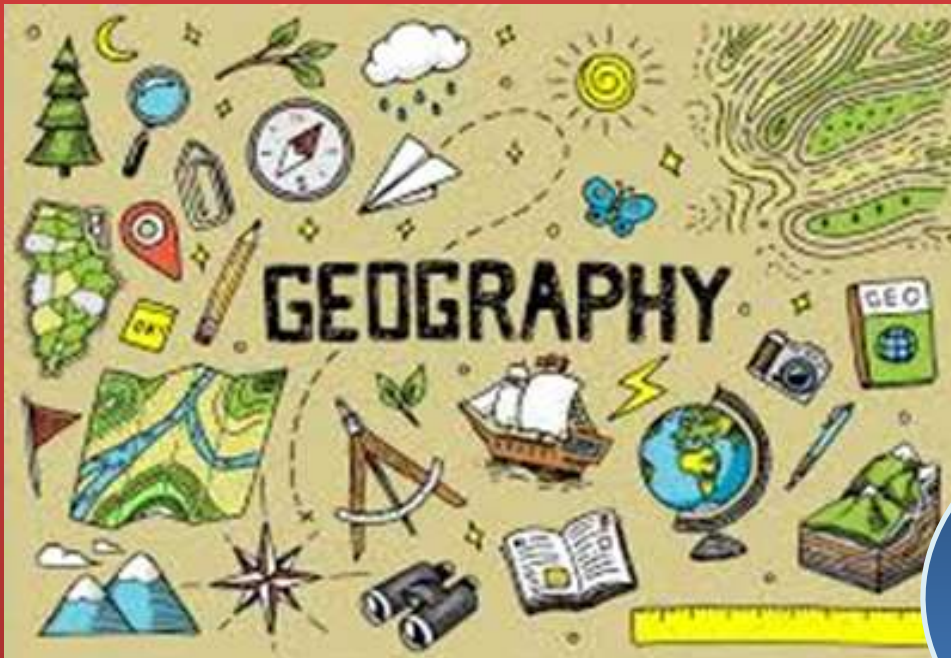
The background of the slide is a map of the Middle East and surrounding regions. The map shows countries like Canada, the United States, Algeria, Libya, Egypt, Saudi Arabia, Iraq, Iran, Afghanistan, Pakistan, India, and Russia. The map is color-coded with various shades of green, yellow, and brown. The title 'Geography of Pakistan' is overlaid on a red rectangular box in the upper center of the map.

Geography of Pakistan

Lecture 01

- National & International Borders
 - Mountain Ranges
 - Rivers In Pakistan
 - Deserts In Pakistan
- Geo-political Significance Of Pakistan

What is Geography

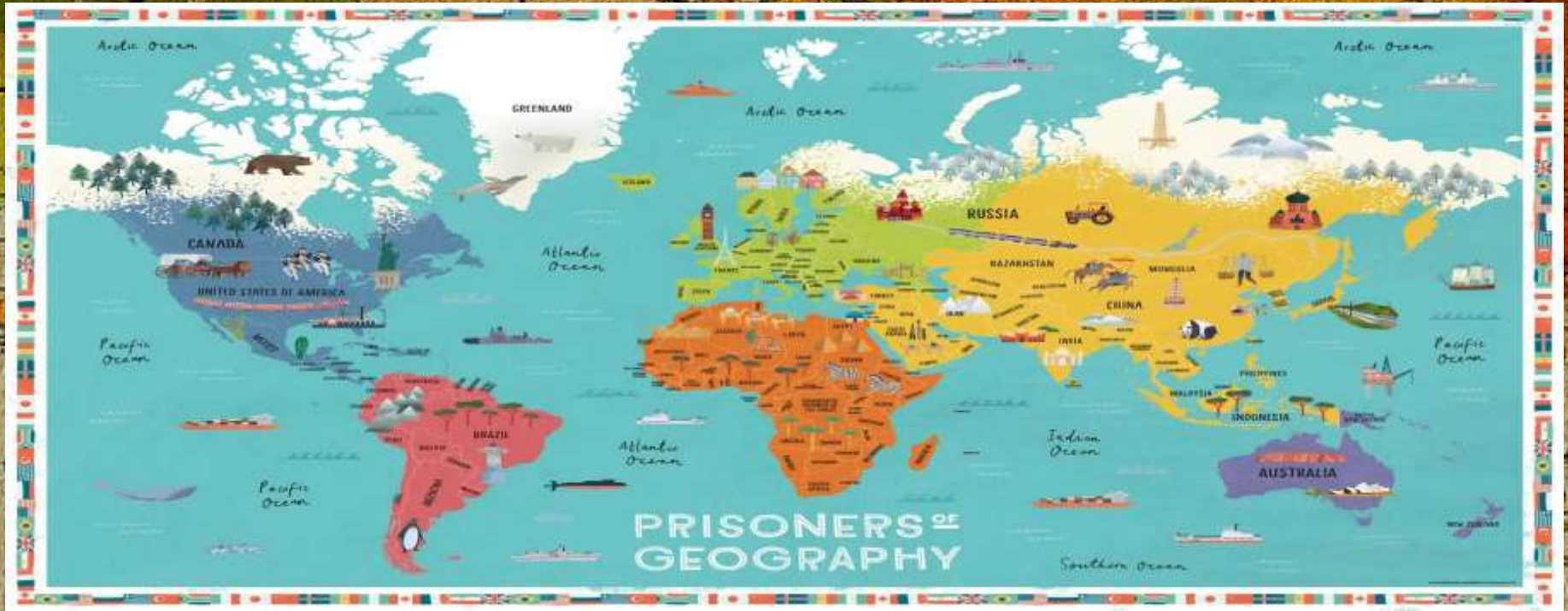


Geography" is made up of two Greek root words

1. **Geo:** Meaning *Earth*
2. **Graphy:** Meaning *to write or to describe*

**So, Geography
literally means
“to write about
the Earth” or
“description of
the Earth.**

What is GEOGRAPHY?



Geography is the study of the lands, features, inhabitants, and phenomena of Earth.

Geography is an all-encompassing discipline that seeks an understanding of Earth and its human and natural complexities—not merely where objects are, but also how they have changed and come to be.

Definition



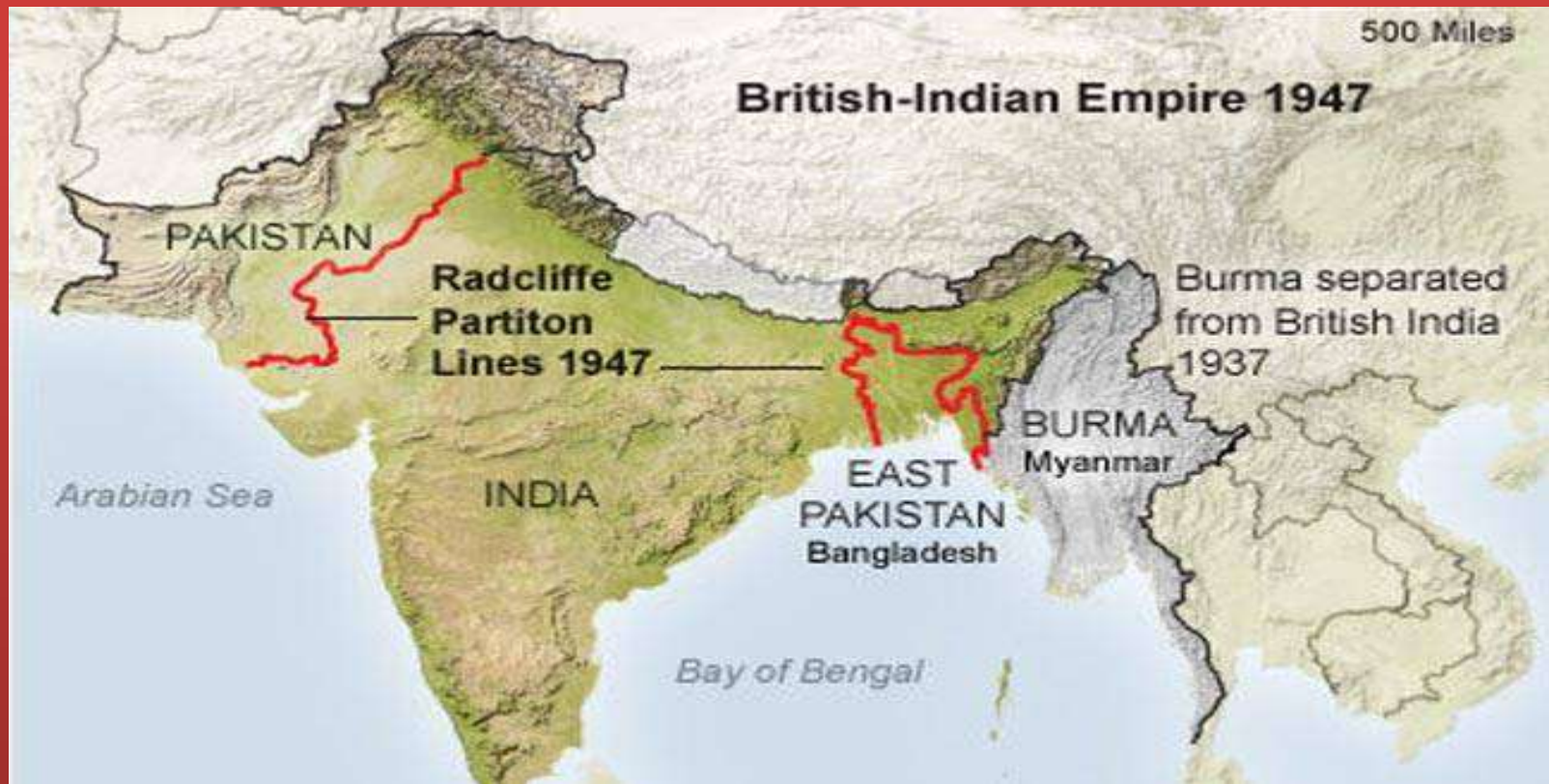
Geography is the study of the diverse environments, places, and spaces on Earth's surface and their interactions. It seeks to answer the questions of why things are the way they are and where they are.

Geography of Pakistan

What is geography of Pakistan?



Pakistan as of 1947



Partition Map

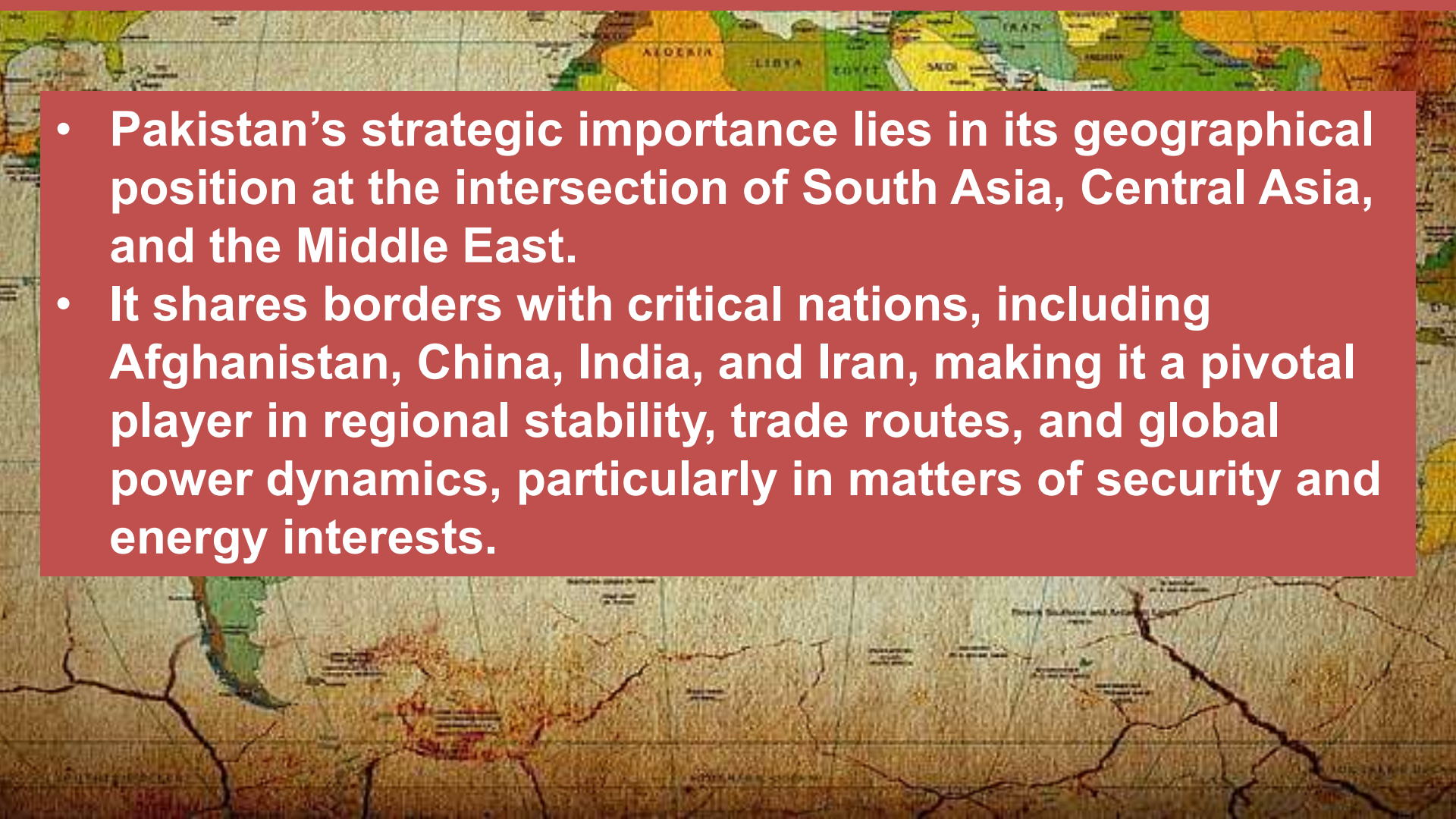


Pakistan as of Today



Pakistan shares its borders with four neighboring countries and has a coastline as well.

What is GEO STRATEGIC IMPORTANCE OF PAKISTAN's Location?

- 
- Pakistan's strategic importance lies in its geographical position at the intersection of South Asia, Central Asia, and the Middle East.
 - It shares borders with critical nations, including Afghanistan, China, India, and Iran, making it a pivotal player in regional stability, trade routes, and global power dynamics, particularly in matters of security and energy interests.

Location of Pakistan

**Location: South Asia,
Bordering the Arabian Sea, between
India on the East and Iran and
Afghanistan on the West and China
in the North.**

- 30 00 N, 70 00 E
- Total Area: 881,913 sq/km (approx.)
- land: 778,720 sq km
- water: 25,220 sq km
- Coast line: 1,046 km (approx.)
- Climate: mostly hot and dry
- Natural resources: land, extensive natural gas reserves, limited petroleum, coal, iron ore, copper, salt, limestone



Pakistan's internal borders with:

- Punjab: 205,344 sq km
- Sindh: 140,914 sq km
- Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (KPK): 101,741 sq km
- Baluchistan: 347,190 sq km
- Islamabad Capital Territory: 906 sq km
- Gilgit-Baltistan: 72,971 sq km
- Azad Jammu and Kashmir: 13,297 sq km

Pakistan's external borders with (West Pakistan)

1. India – to the east

- Shares a long and historically significant border.

2. Afghanistan – to the northwest

- Separated by the **Durand Line**, a historically disputed boundary.

3. Iran – to the west

- Shares cultural and trade ties with Pakistan.

4. China – to the northeast

- Connected through the **Karakoram Highway** and a strong strategic relationship.

5. Arabian Sea – to the south

- Provides Pakistan with access to sea trade through ports like **Karachi** and **Gwadar**.

East Pakistan (Present-day Bangladesh)

- **North, West, and East:** Surrounded by **India** (West Bengal, Assam, and Tripura)
- **Southeast:** Small border with **Burma (Myanmar)** in the Chittagong Hill Tracts.
- **South:** Coastal boundary along the **Bay of Bengal**.
- In 1971, East Pakistan became independent as Bangladesh after a war with West Pakistan.

Boarder Issues: North

- **Afghanistan** (Durand Line, a disputed boundary established in 1893 but not formally accepted by Afghanistan).

Durand Line



Boarder Issues: Northeast

- **Bordering China**
(via the Kashmir region, though the exact border was undefined due to the Kashmir conflict)





Gilgit Baltistan
(Pakistani Control)

Gifted to China

Aksai Chin
(Occupied by China
since 1962
Indo China War)

Azad Kashmir
(Pakistani Control)

Jammu & Kashmir (India)

CHINA

Territory ceded
by Pakistan to
China in 1963
(Shaksgam Valley)

Wakhan Corridor

Teram Shehr

Siachen Glacier

Karakorm
Pass

Gilgit

Pakistan
Occupied
Kashmir

Baltistan

Bilafond La

Skardu

NJ 9842

Depsang La

Aksai Chin

Patrol
Point 14

Galwan Valley

Pangong-TSO
Lake

Shyok

Nubra Valley

Leh

Jammu &
Kashmir

LADAKH

Zoji La

Kargil

LOC
Line Of
Control

LAC
Line
of Actual
Control

Demchok

PAK

INDIA

CLASHES ALONG THE LAC

May 5 Indian and Chinese soldiers clash at Pangong TSO lake.

May 10 Face-off at the Muguthang Valley in Sikkim.

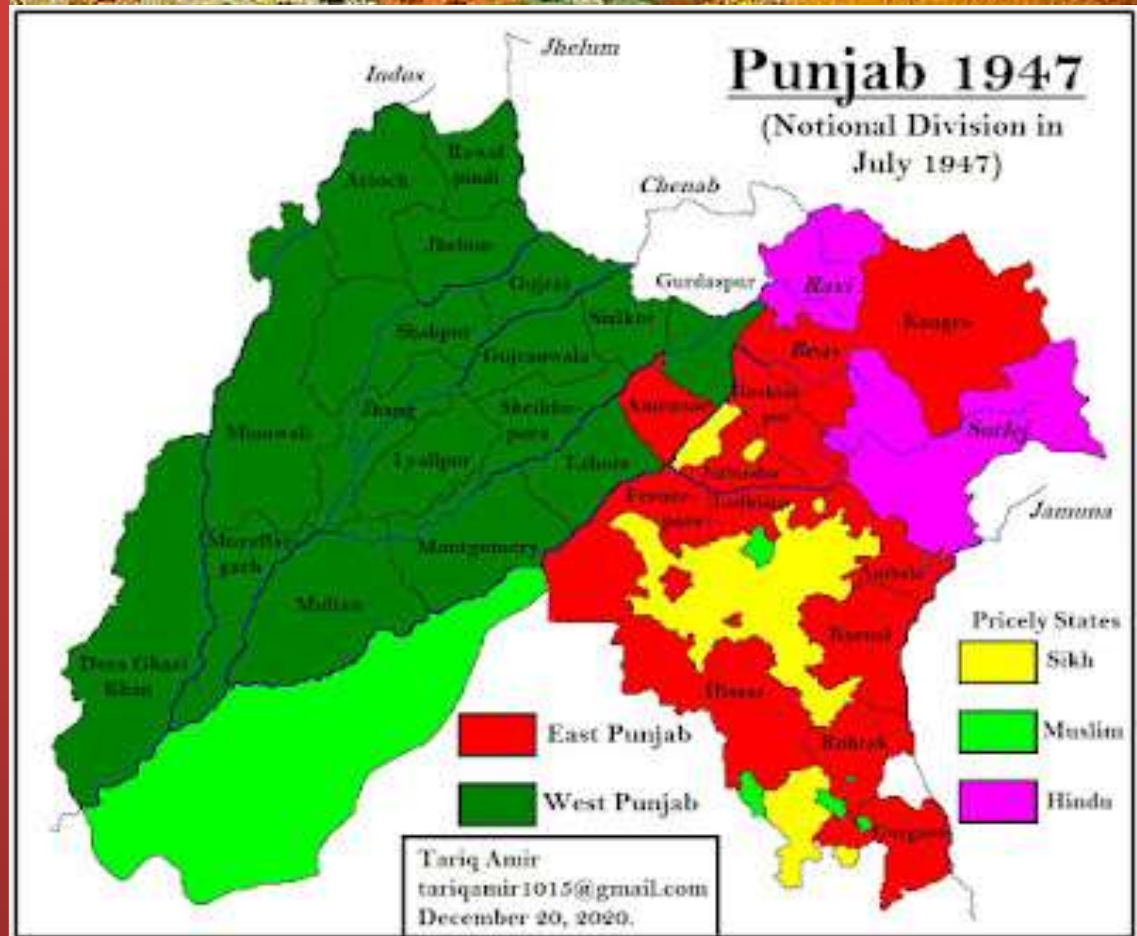
May 21 Chinese troops enter into the Galwan River Valley in Ladakh region.

May 24 Chinese camps at 3 places: Hotspring, P14 and P15.

June 15 Violent Face-off* between Indian and Chinese Soldiers. A Colonel and 19 soldiers martyred from the Indian side while China (PLA) suffered 43 to 49 casualties including a Colonel, killed in the scuffle

Boarder Issues: East

- **Bordering India** (Radcliffe Line, demarcating West Pakistan from Indian Punjab and Rajasthan).



Border Issues: **West**

- **Bordering Iran (Balochistan region).**



Kashmir



Administrative Divisions

Pakistan is divided into 4 provinces, 2 autonomous territories, and 1 federal territory:

- **Punjab** (Lahore) – Most populous.
- **Sindh** (Karachi) – Economic hub.
- **Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (KP)** (Peshawar) – Mountainous, Pashtun-majority.
- **Balochistan** (Quetta) – Largest by area, least populated.
- **Gilgit-Baltistan (GB)** – Autonomous, northern mountains.
- **Azad Jammu & Kashmir (AJK)** – Disputed region.
- **Islamabad Capital Territory (ICT)** – Federal capital

Administrative Divisions

DIFFERENCE BETWEEN PROVINCE AND AUTONOMOUS TERRITORY

Feature	Province	Autonomous Territory
Constitutional Status	Fully recognized in constitution	Special / separate legal status
Representation in Parliament	Yes (National Assembly & Senate)	Limited or none
Level of Self-Government	Standard	Higher in local matters
Federal Control	Limited	Greater

Key Geographical Challenges

- **Water Scarcity:** Dependence on Indus River, disputes with India.
- **Earthquakes:** Located on Eurasian-Indian tectonic plates (e.g., 2005 Kashmir earthquake).
- **Desertification:** Thar and Cholistan expanding.
- **Floods:** Monsoon rains cause Indus River flooding (e.g., 2010 floods).

WHAT ARE IMPORTANT GEOGRAPHICAL FEATURES OF PAKISTAN?

Pakistan is divided into three major geographic areas:

- (a) The Northern Highlands;*
- (b) The Indus River Plain (with two major subdivisions corresponding roughly to the provinces of Punjab and Sindh); and*
- (c) the Baluchistan Plateau.*



Pakistan's Diverse Internal Geography Overview

The Northern & Northwestern Mountains

- **Himalayas, Karakoram, and Hindu Kush** ranges dominate this region.
- Home to some of the world's highest peaks, including **K2 (8,611 m)**, the second-highest mountain on Earth.
- Important passes: **Khyber Pass** (connects Pakistan to Afghanistan), **Bolan Pass** (links Balochistan to Afghanistan).
- Glaciers like **Siachen** (world's highest battlefield) and **Biafo** are found here.

Pakistan Physical Features

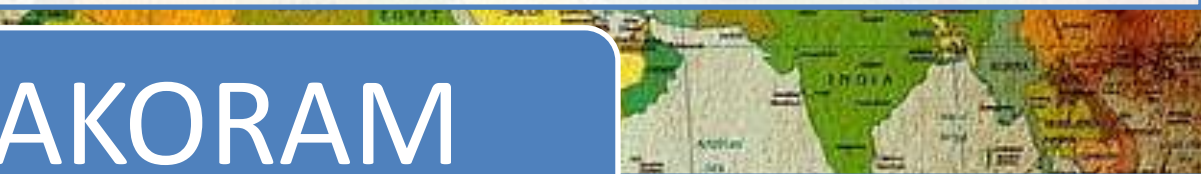
- ✓ The Northern Mountains
- ✓ The Western Mountains
- ✓ The Punjab Plain,
- ✓ The Sind Plain
- ✓ Baluchistan Plateau
- ✓ Potohar Plateau
- ✓ Deserts





HINDUKUSH

Its is located at the North-West. (Pak-Afghan Border)
Tirich Mir located in Chitral (25,289ft) is the highest point in Hindukush.



KARAKORAM

Present in India, Pakistan and China.
K2- is the highest peak (world's 2nd highest), 8611 meters (28,251ft) high **Hindu Raj- between Hindukush & Karakoran. Koyo Zom- Highest Peak**



HIMALAYA

Himalaya is a mountain range in Asia. Mount Everest is the Highest Peak (8,849 m)
Separating the plains of the Indian subcontinent from the Tibetan Plateau. Though India, Nepal, and Bhutan have sovereignty over most of the Himalayas, Pakistan and China also occupy parts of them.

**Northern
Mountain
Ranges**

NANGA PARBAT

Nanga Parbat, known locally as Diamer, is the ninth-highest mountain on Earth and its summit is at 8,126 m above sea level.

Killer Mountain

Elevation: 8,126 m

Mountain range:

[Himalayas](#), [Western Himalayas](#)



WESTERN MOUNTAINS/ Highlands

Western Mountains

1. Safed Koh 4712 meters
2. Waziristan 3513 meters
3. Sulaiman Ranges 3383 meters
4. Kirthar Range 2174 meters
5. Chagai hills 3,009 meters

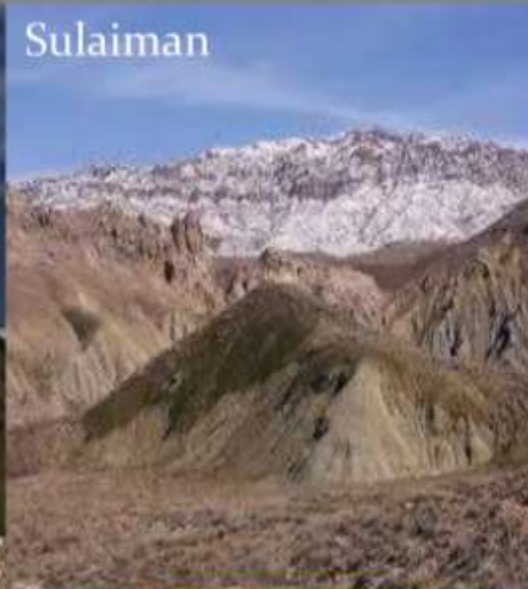


Images of the Western Mountains

Safed Koh



Sulaiman



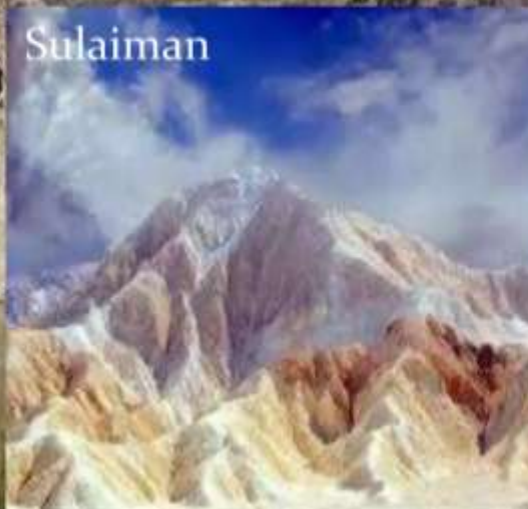
Waziristan



Kirthar



Sulaiman



Waziristan



Waziristan



FEATURES OF WESTERN MOUNTAINS

Mountain	Altitude	Highest peak	Natural resources	Relief	Valleys
Safed Koh East to West	Average 1500 m 4712 meters	Sikaram 4755 m	Limestone ranges	Snowcapped Limited vegetation	Kohat and Vale of Peshawar
Waziristan North to South	3513 meters		Mineralized	North is kurram river south is Gomal river	Bannu Valley
Sulaiman Ranges North to South	3383 meters	Takht-e- Sulaiman 3487 m Zarghun Ghar 3578 m	Limestone and sandstones	Rugged mountain ranges Bridges the Baluchistan plateau & Indus plain	
Kirthar Ranges North to south	2174 meters	Zardak Peak 2260 m	Kirthar National Park	Rugged Vegetation and home for wild animals	

RAS KOH HILLS

Raskoh Hills *is not* Chagai hills

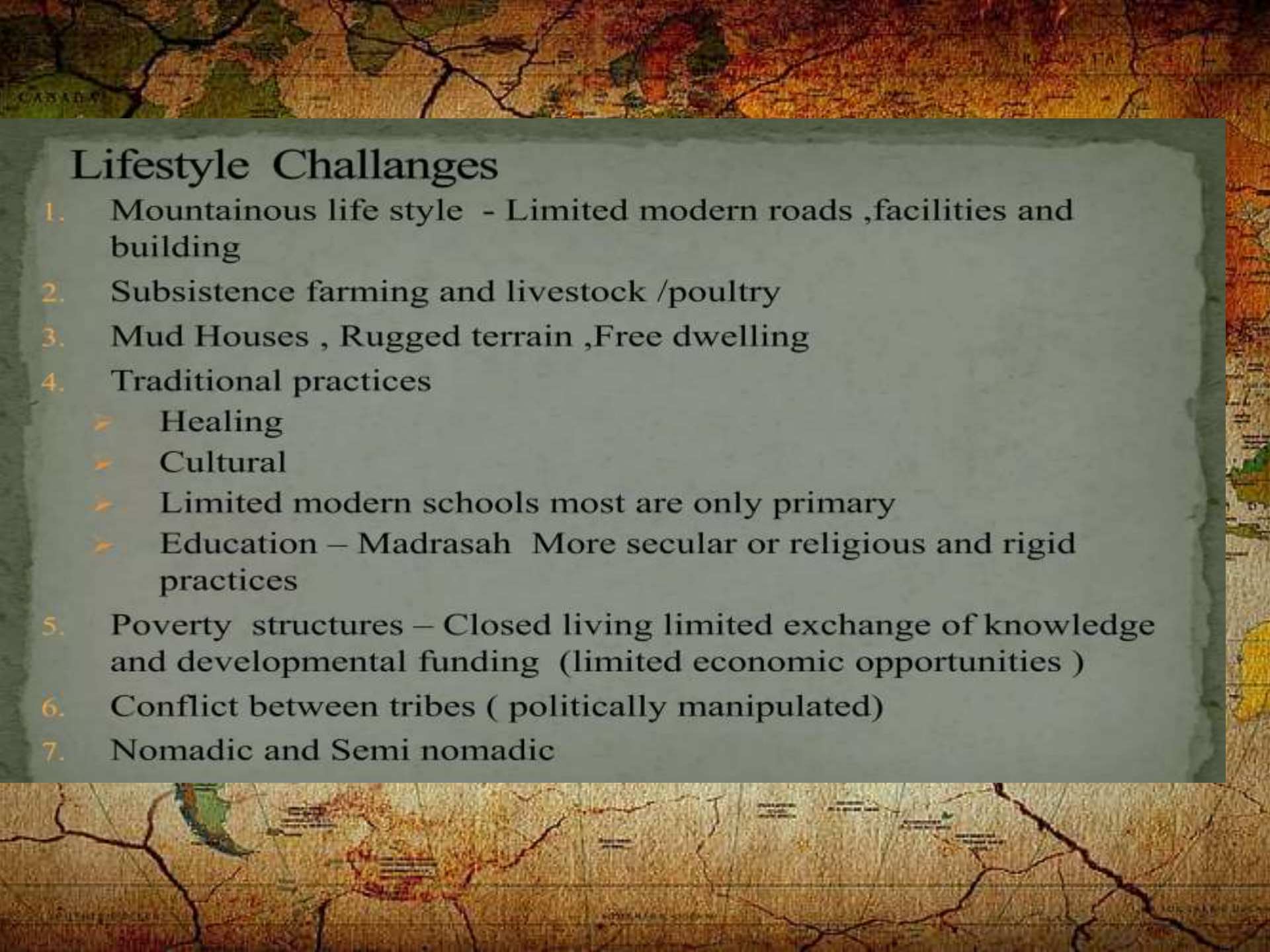


The **Ras Koh Hills** is a range of granite hills forming part of the Sulaiman ranges in the Chagai district of Baluchistan province . The word "Ras" means "gateway" and the word "Koh" means "mountain" in Balochi. Ras Koh, therefore, means "Gateway to the Mountains." Pakistan's first nuclear tests were carried out in the Ras Koh Hills on 28 May 1998.

Life in the western Mountains



Life in the WESTERN MOUNTAINS

The background of the slide is a textured map of the African continent, rendered in warm, earthy tones of brown, orange, and red. The map shows major rivers and country borders. A semi-transparent grey box with a torn-paper edge contains the text.

Lifestyle Challenges

1. Mountainous life style - Limited modern roads ,facilities and building
2. Subsistence farming and livestock /poultry
3. Mud Houses , Rugged terrain ,Free dwelling
4. Traditional practices
 - Healing
 - Cultural
 - Limited modern schools most are only primary
 - Education – Madrasah More secular or religious and rigid practices
5. Poverty structures – Closed living limited exchange of knowledge and developmental funding (limited economic opportunities)
6. Conflict between tribes (politically manipulated)
7. Nomadic and Semi nomadic

Historical Passes in the Western Mountains

Khyber Pass	It is in the Hindu Kush. It is a passage between Peshawar in KPK and Kabul in Afghanistan
Tochi pass	It is in the Safed Koh mountain in KPK. It is a passage between Bannu in Pakistan to Ghazni in Afghanistan
Gomal	It is in the South Waziristan Hills of KPK. It connects Ghazni in Afghanistan with Tank and Dera Ismail Khan in Pakistan.
Kurram	It is in the south Waziristan hills and is a connection with the Gomal route .It makes a passage from Kurram valley just at the foot hill of Safed Koh to Afghanistan
Bolan Pass	It is in the Suleman Ranges, It connects Jaccobabad in Sind to Sibbi to Quetta

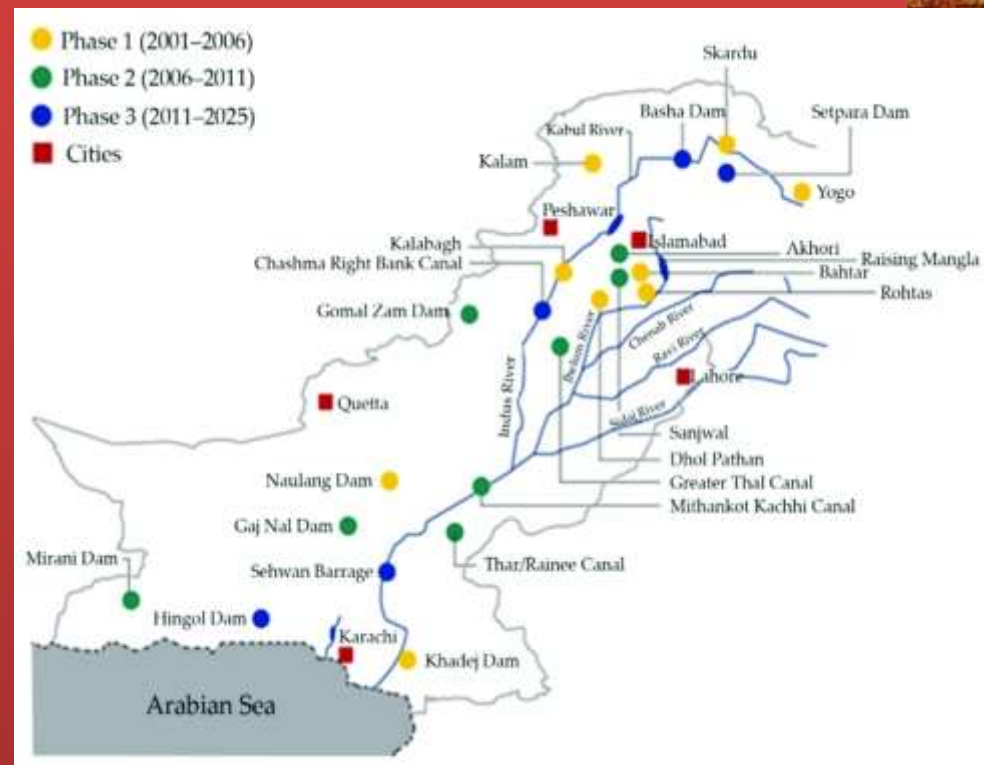
The Baluchistan Plateau

- A dry, rugged region covering about **44% of Pakistan's land area.**
- **Sparse population** due to arid climate and mountainous terrain.
- Key features:
 - **Sulaiman Mountains and Toba Kakar Range.**
 - **Hingol National Park** (largest in Pakistan).
 - **Quetta** is the major city, prone to earthquakes.

The Indus Plain (Punjab & Sindh)

- The most fertile and densely populated region.
- Formed by the **Indus River** and its tributaries (**Jhelum, Chenab, Ravi, Sutlej, Beas**).
- Divided into:
 - **Upper Indus Plain (Punjab)**: Intensive agriculture (wheat, rice, cotton).
 - **Lower Indus Plain (Sindh)**: Includes the **Indus Delta** near Karachi.

RIVERS IN PAKISTAN



Major Rivers & Water Systems

- **Indus River:** Lifeline of Pakistan (~3,200 km long).
- **Tributaries:** *Jhelum, Chenab, Ravi, Sutlej* (forming the **Punjab** – "Land of Five Rivers").
- **Dams & Barrages:**
 - **Tarbela Dam** (world's largest earth-filled dam).
 - **Mangla Dam.**
 - **Indus Basin Irrigation System** (largest contiguous irrigation system globally).

Coastal Areas (Arabian Sea)

- **Makran Coast (Balochistan):** Rocky and less developed.
- **Sindh Coast:** Includes **Karachi** (largest city & port) and the **Indus Delta**.

The Thar Desert (Southeastern Pakistan)

Deserts in Pakistan



- Extends into India (Rajasthan).
- Arid climate, with sand dunes and limited vegetation.
- Cholistan Desert (in Punjab) is an extension.

Climate Zones

- **Highland Climate (North):** Cold winters, mild summers (e.g., Gilgit-Baltistan).
- **Arid & Semi-Arid (Balochistan, Thar):** Very hot, little rainfall.
- **Subtropical (Punjab, Sindh):** Hot summers, mild winters, monsoon rains.
- **Coastal (Karachi, Gwadar):** Moderate temperatures, humid.

Ecological Regions

- **Forests:** Coniferous (north), mangrove (Indus Delta).
- **Wildlife:** Snow leopards (north), Indus dolphins, Markhor (national animal).
- **Protected Areas:**
 - **Hingol National Park** (Balochistan).
 - **Deosai Plains** ("Land of Giants," Gilgit-Baltistan).

Importance of Pakistan

- Strategic Location
- China-Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC)
- Geopolitical Buffer Zone
- Security and Defense Considerations
- Agricultural Significance
- Cultural and Historical Crossroads



Geo politics???

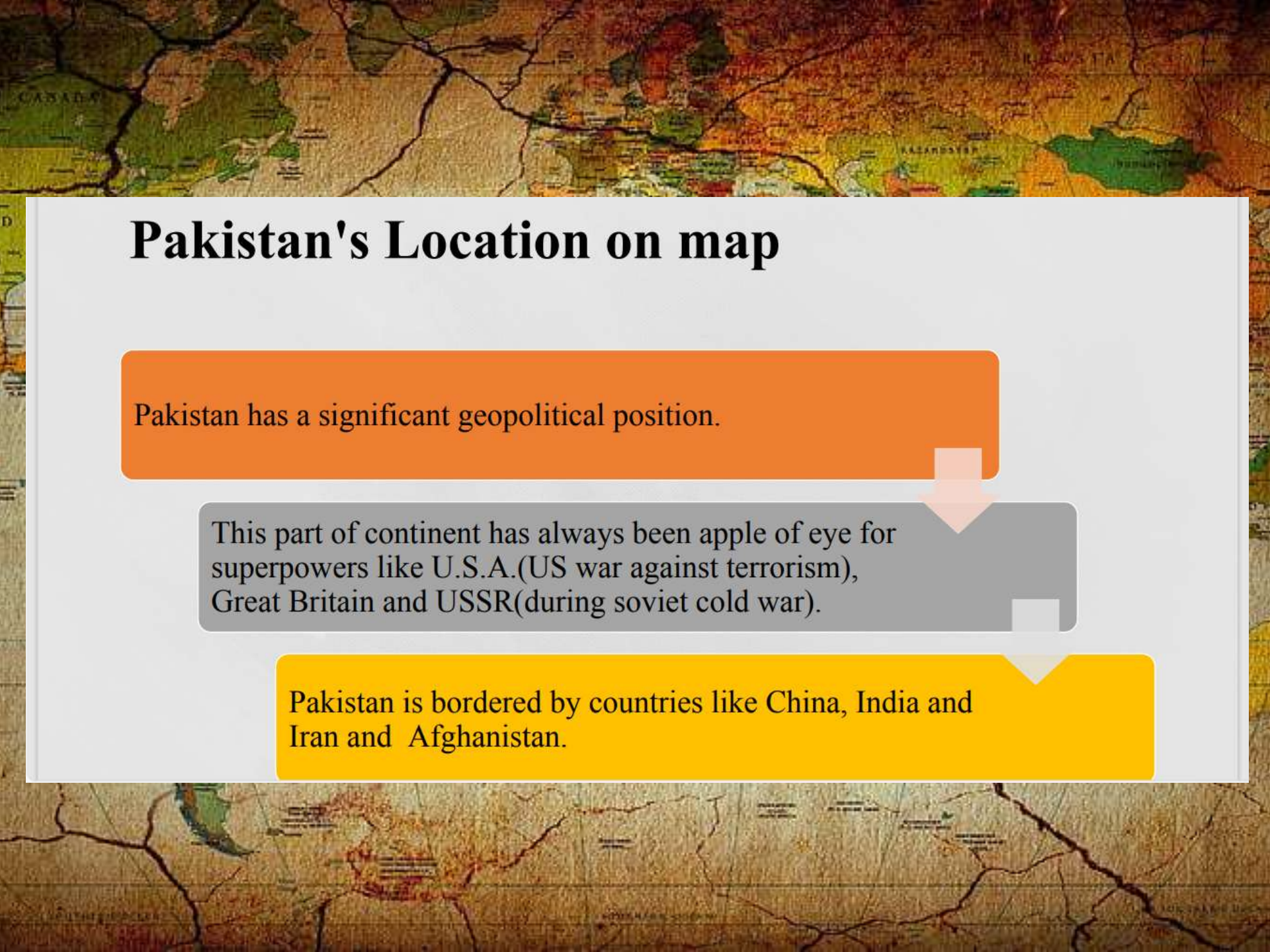
- The impact created by a country on other neighbouring countries due to its geopolitical position is called geopolitics.
 - This impact also affects the politics of the region as a whole.
- 



Question

- What is Important in Pakistan's Geography?



The background of the slide is a detailed, textured map of South Asia and surrounding regions. It shows the borders of India, Pakistan, China, and Afghanistan, along with major rivers and geographical features. The map is rendered in a classic, slightly aged style with various shades of green, brown, and yellow.

Pakistan's Location on map

Pakistan has a significant geopolitical position.

This part of continent has always been apple of eye for superpowers like U.S.A.(US war against terrorism), Great Britain and USSR(during soviet cold war).

Pakistan is bordered by countries like China, India and Iran and Afghanistan.

The Strategic Importance of Pakistan: A Geo-strategic Nexus



- **Geopolitical Significance**

- 1- Bridge between South Asia and Central Asia

- 2- Balancing Power Dynamics

Pakistan connects the oil-rich Middle East with energy-hungry South and East Asia, making it a vital transit country.

- **Proximity to Major Powers:** Shares borders with China, India, Afghanistan, and Iran, placing it at the heart of several major regional power dynamics.

- **Access to the Arabian Sea:** The coastline along the Arabian Sea provides crucial sea trade routes and access to warm waters year-round, enhancing naval and trade capabilities.

- **Economic Significance**

- 1- Trade and Energy Corridor

- 2- Agriculture and Resource Potential

- **Security Significance**

- 1- Counterterrorism Efforts

- 2- Nuclear Arsenal

- **Regional Dynamics of Pakistan**

- 1- Relationship with India

- 2- Role in Afghanistan

- 3- Relationship with Iran

- **Pakistan's Global Partnerships**

United States-Pakistan Collaboration

China-Pakistan Friendship

- **Strategic Significance and Challenges for Pakistan**

1- Security Concerns

2- Terrorism

3- Geopolitical Rivalry

4- Economic Development

Opportunities and Benefits of Pakistan's Strategic Importance

1- China-Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC)

2- Regional Connectivity

3- Counterterrorism Cooperation

4- Diplomacy and Reconciliation

Indo-Pak Neighbourhood

Independence of Pakistan in 1947

Relations between India and Pakistan gone through many ups and down.

Firstly: On the distribution of asserts

Secondly: Muslim majority areas were allotted to India.

Resulted into wars, conflicts and military standoffs.

Indo-Pak Wars

Indo-Pakistani War of 1947
Indo-Pakistani War of
1947–1948

1947

Indo-Pakistani War of 1971
Indo-Pakistani War of
1971 and Bangladesh Liberation
War

1971

1965

Indo-Pakistani War of 1965
Indo-Pakistani War of 1965

1999

Indo-Pakistani War of 1999
Kargil War

Indo–Pakistan Wars & Limited Conflicts (1947–2025)

Year(s)	Conflict / Event	Nature	Main Cause	Outcome / Status
1947–1948	First Kashmir War	Full-scale war	Accession of Jammu & Kashmir	UN ceasefire; Kashmir divided along LoC
1965	Second Indo–Pakistan War	Full-scale war	Kashmir dispute; Operation Gibraltar	Tashkent Agreement (1966); status quo
1971	Third Indo–Pakistan War	Full-scale war	East Pakistan crisis; Indian intervention	Creation of Bangladesh; Simla Agreement (1972)

Indo–Pakistan Wars & Limited Conflicts (1947–2025)

1984–Present	Siachen Conflict	Limited military conflict	Dispute over Siachen Glacier	Indian control; ongoing military deployment
1999	Kargil Conflict	Limited war	Infiltration across LoC	Restoration of LoC; diplomatic fallout
2001–2002	Military Standoff	Near-war crisis	Attack on Indian Parliament	Troop mobilization; war avoided
2016	Uri Crisis	Limited conflict	Attack on Indian army base	India claimed surgical strikes; tensions

Indo–Pakistan Wars & Limited Conflicts (1947–2025)

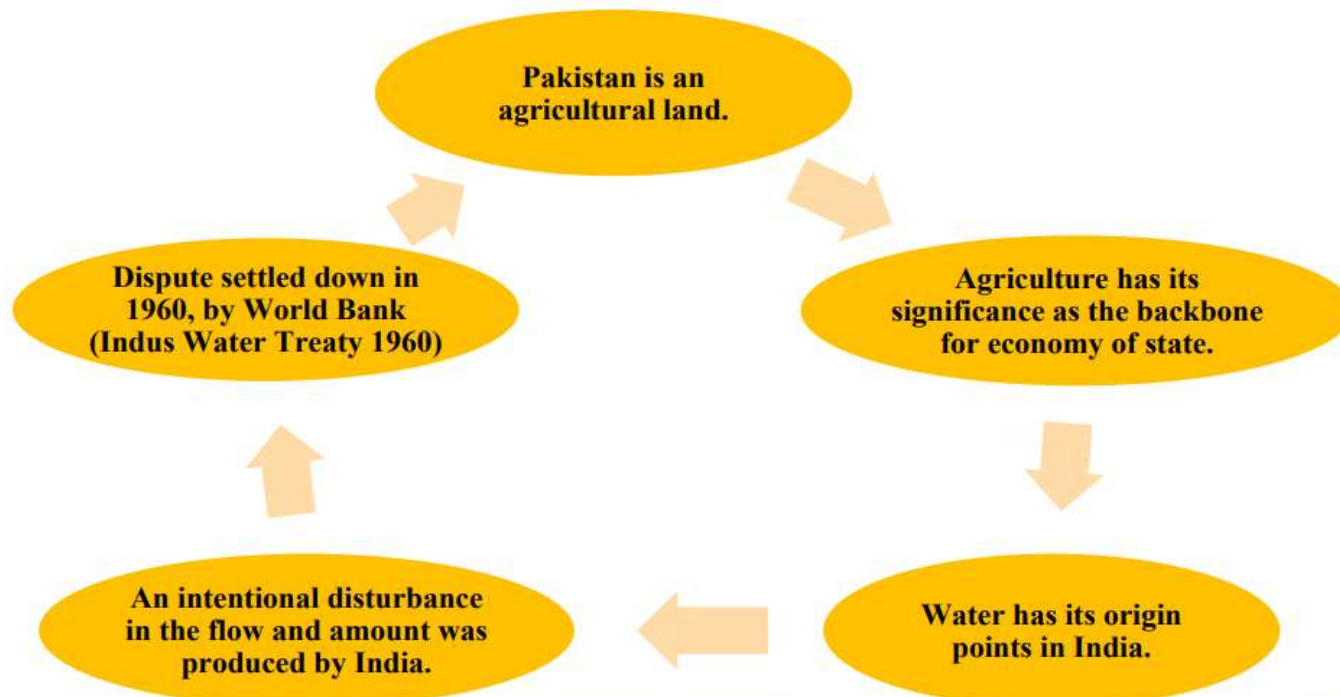
2019	Pulwama–Balakot Crisis	Limited aerial conflict	Pulwama suicide attack	Air engagements; pilot exchange; de-escalation
2020–2024	LoC Ceasefire Violations	Low-intensity conflict	Border firing, political tensions	2021 ceasefire agreement largely held
2025	Indo–Pakistan Crisis (Hybrid & Border Tensions)	Limited / Hybrid conflict	LoC incidents, cyber & information warfare, diplomatic strain	No declared war; tensions managed through diplomacy

Wars: 1947–48, 1965, 1971

Limited conflicts / crises: 1984, 1999, 2001–02, 2016, 2019, 2025

2025 is NOT a declared war, but is correctly included as a limited / hybrid conflict

Water Issue between India & Pakistan



Bone of contention

At the time of division, Kashmir was a Muslim majority state with a non-Muslim ruler.

He made a deal and gave away the state to India. People of state stood against this injustice and started movement for freedom.

As a result of which, half part of state was taken back by freedom fighters. The rest of state is still Indian Territory.

On 5 August 2019, the government of India revoked the constitutional status of the state of Jammu and Kashmir under Article 370 of the Constitution, and abrogated Article 35A which had allowed it to define who its 'permanent residents' are and what rights and privileges are attached to such residency.

Pak-Iran brother hood

Pakistan relations with Iran were initiated at the time of its independence.

Iran was the very first country to accept Pakistan as newly born Muslim country.

Pakistan warmly welcomed the Islamic revolution in Iran in 1979; Pakistan played its role for stopping the prolonged gulf war in the region.

Free Trade Agreement

Now a days Pakistan and Iran are in strong trading ties.

In 2005, Iran and Pakistan had conducted US\$500 million of trade in electricity and oil.

Iran is extending its railway network towards Tafton.

'The Iran-Pakistan-India pipeline is currently under discussion. It could be a major development between all three nations.

A gas pipe line project is also under discussions between the countries.

As a part of Muslim world, both play their prominent role for the betterment of Muslim umah.

Sino-Pakistan Brotherhood

Chino-Pak brotherhood needs no words for explication.

These two neighbours are very close to each other.

Pakistan and china have strong relations from 1949.

Since that time, both are supporting each other in all aspects.

Pakistan helped china in being the member of United Nations.

China's significant moral and strategic support played important role during the wars of 1965 and 1971.

One of the cogent evidences of Chino-Pak friendship is Karakorum highway.

Now China is providing technical aid to Pakistan in establishing the Gawadar port, an international hub for trade.



Gawadar has become a key point in settling the economy of Pakistan.

It has greatly enhanced the importance of Pakistan in the era.

This project is being completed by both china and Pakistan and an evidence of chino-Pak brotherhood.

It will bring a revolution in trade after being operational. Not only Pakistan but the entire region will be among its beneficiaries.

Gawadar port will prove itself as backbone in the economy of Pakistan. As well as it will lessen the burden on Port Qasim.

Pakistan's relations with gulf region are also nearly based upon Gawadar port.





Pak-afghan ties

Pakistan shares its long boundary with Afghanistan.

Afghanistan is a Muslim country which has been in state of war from several decades.

Pakistan, being the nearer Muslim nation has always been playing its role for establishing peace in Afghanistan. During soviet cold war, Pakistan helped afghan Muslim government to get rid from USSR.

After the 9/11 attacks, Pakistan joined hands with all world and played eminent part in US war against terrorism. Pakistan provided its army bases and land routes for supplying goods.

In consequences of that, the number of terrorist activities in Pakistan enhanced greatly and Pakistan is still suffering from internal problems.

Another major issue is the sprouting traffic of drugs. This is the source of finance for the militants too.

Both countries are trying to solve these security issues.

Arabian sea

Pakistan shares one of its borders with Arabian Sea which is of high importance.

It plays an important role for the economy of state because Pakistan makes its level best merchandizes through water.



Pak-Russia relations

Pakistan is always eager to keep friendly relations with the nations all over the world.

In 1950, Pakistan preferred America over Russia.

In 1949, Soviet Union sent an invitation to Prime Minister Liaquat Ali Khan to visit the country, followed by the U.S. invitation.

In May 1950, Prime Minister Ali Khan paid a state visit to the United States after being persuaded to snap ties with the Soviet Union,

During soviet war, Pakistan stood with Afghanistan and assisted America in casting out USSR.

Now days both countries are willing to cooperate with each other in the field of commerce and industry.

Russia has no access to warm waters so it seeks alternate routes for trading.

Most nearest water route is through Pakistan so it needs Pakistan for its trade. This is the key of Pak Russia relations.



Pak-American relationships

Pakistan relations with America have gone through many ups and downs during the past. In the earlier days, Pakistan preferred America over Russia as described earlier.

During 1965 war, America did not provide any help to Pakistan regardless of having strong economic and strategic ties.

The same story was repeated during 1971 war.

In the cold war Pakistan became the right hand of America in kicking Russia out of the region.

A new era of relations established between Pakistan and America after 9/11 attacks.

As a reward of this support, America furnishes Pakistan with financial aid and strategic assistance.

Pakistan is still under its consequences.

During this war a new wave of terrorism entered in Pakistan that harmed Pakistan badly.

This caused anger in Afghan localities against Pakistan.

Keeping harmony with all the world, Pakistan joined hands with United Nations and provided its land and routes for the attacking forces.

America has a remarkable influence in the national politics of Pakistan also.

America tries to establish a government in Pakistan that would care about American profits in the region.

Some Pakistani think tanks suggest ending up relations with America but that is not an option worth choosing.

Anyhow, Pakistan should maintain friendly relations with America.

Strategic Location



China-Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC)

- **Gateway to Central Asia and China:** Gwadar Port in Balochistan connects Western China to the Arabian Sea, reducing China's dependence on the Strait of Malacca.
- **Economic Lifeline:** CPEC enhances Pakistan's infrastructure and energy sectors, increasing its geopolitical value for China and the wider Belt and Road Initiative.

China-Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC)



Geopolitical Buffer Zone

- Historically served as a **buffer state** during the Cold War between Soviet influence in Afghanistan and Western-aligned states.
- Acts as a **frontline state** in the fight against terrorism, especially in the post-9/11 era.

Security and Defense Considerations

- **Eastern Border with India:** The Line of Control (LoC) in Kashmir remains a hotspot, making geography central to Pakistan's defense and strategic calculations.
- **Western Border with Afghanistan:** Porous and mountainous, it poses both opportunities and challenges in terms of security, trade, and migration.

Agricultural Significance

- The **Indus River System** supports one of the largest irrigation networks in the world, making Pakistan's plains fertile and agriculturally productive.
- Geography heavily influences the economy, with agriculture being a significant sector due to the river-based ecosystem.

Cultural and Historical Crossroads

- Historically a passageway for **invading empires**, traders, and cultural exchanges (e.g., Alexander the Great, the Mughals, Silk Road trade).
- This gives Pakistan a rich cultural heritage and diverse population shaped by centuries of movement and interaction.

Projects

- TAPI Pipeline (Turkmenistan-Afghanistan-Pakistan-India)
- CASA-1000 (Central Asia South Asia Electricity Transmission and Trade Project)
- CPEC (China-Pakistan Economic Corridor)

TAPI Pipeline (Turkmenistan-Afghanistan-Pakistan-India)



TAPI Pipeline (Turkmenistan-Afghanistan-Pakistan-India)



TAPI Pipeline (Turkmenistan-Afghanistan-Pakistan-India)

- A natural gas pipeline aiming to transport gas from the **Galkynysh Gas Field** in Turkmenistan through **Afghanistan and Pakistan to India**.
- Total length: ~1,814 km
- Pakistan segment: Enters via **Chaman**, Baluchistan, and exits to India via **Multan**.

TAPI Pipeline (Turkmenistan-Afghanistan-Pakistan-India)

- **Geographic Significance for Pakistan:**
- **Energy Corridor:** Pakistan serves as a **geographic bridge** between Central Asia and South Asia, making it vital for energy transit.
- **Regional Connectivity:** Strengthens Pakistan's **economic and diplomatic ties** with Central Asian states.
- **Strategic Leverage:** Reinforces Pakistan's position as a key **transit hub**—turning geography into geo-economics.
- **Balochistan's Role:** TAPI passes through a **security-sensitive region**, emphasizing how internal geographic challenges (like militancy or separatist movements) intersect with international projects.

CASA-1000 (Central Asia South Asia Electricity Transmission and Trade Project)

- Transmits surplus hydroelectric power from Kyrgyzstan and Tajikistan to Afghanistan and Pakistan, especially during summer.
- Pakistan's receiving point is Peshawar, linking it to the national grid.



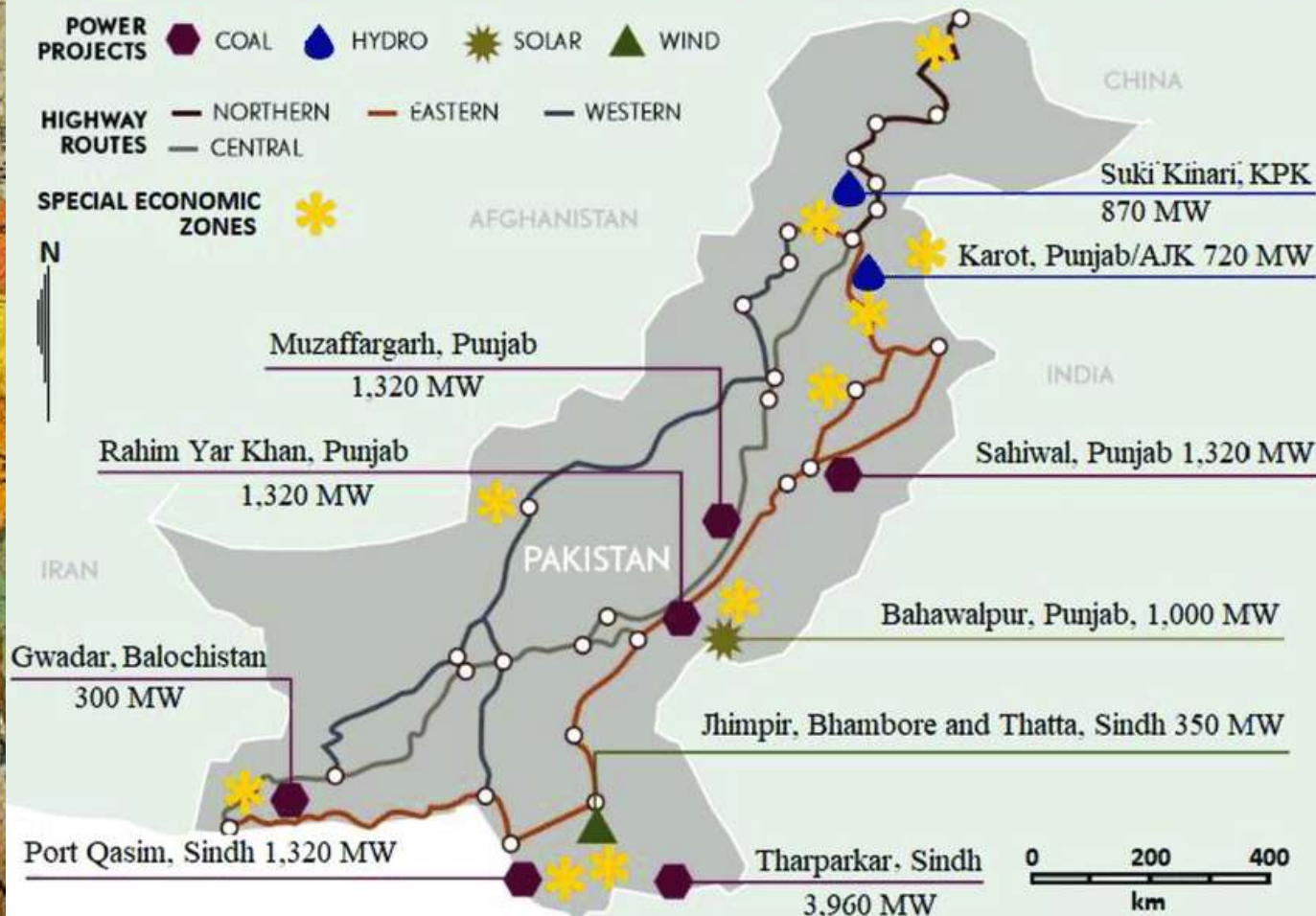
CASA-1000

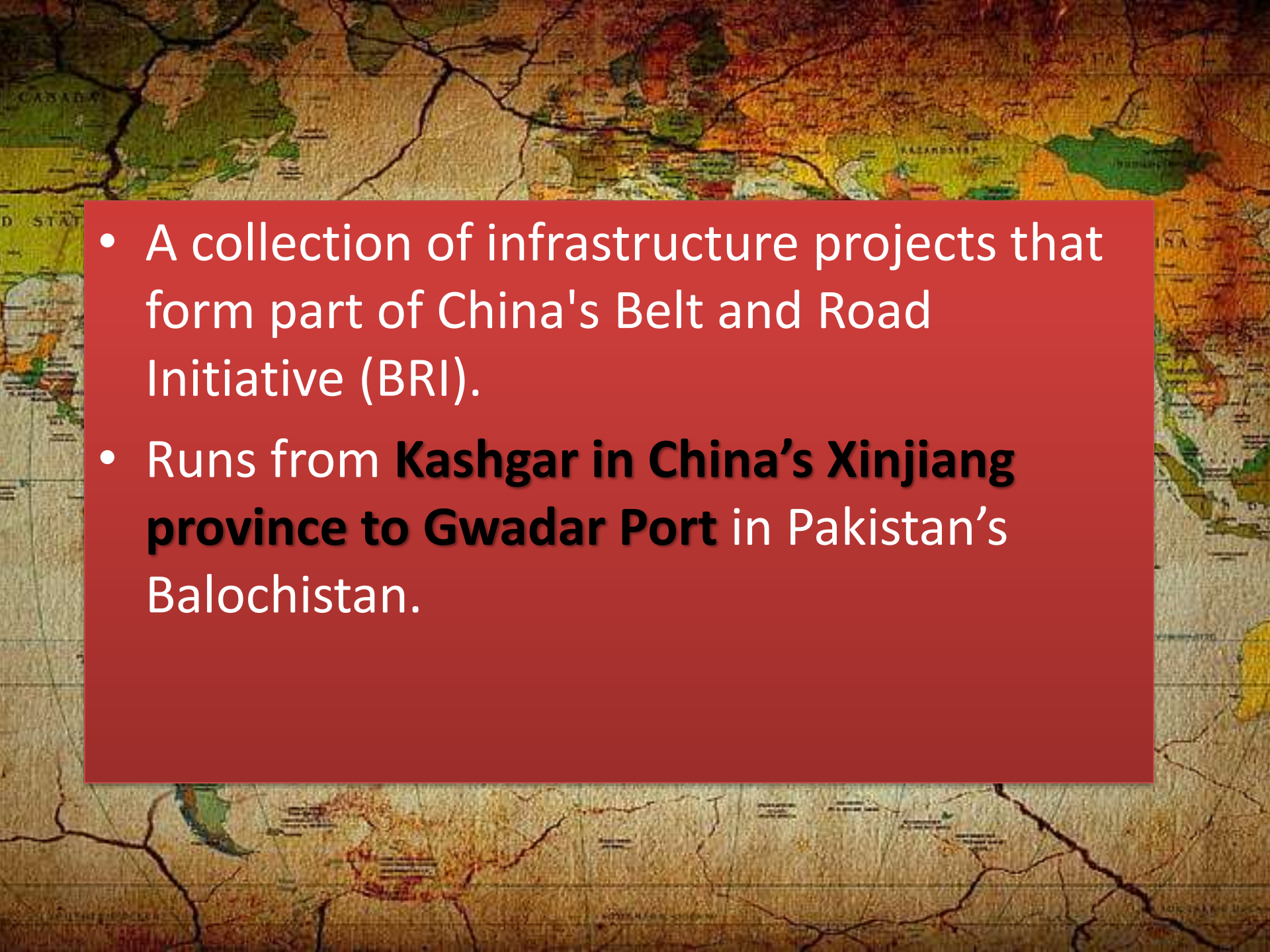
Geographic Significance for Pakistan

- **Energy Diversification:** Takes advantage of Pakistan's **geographic proximity** to hydro-rich Central Asia.
- **Northern Terrain Utilized:** The route through **Khyber Pakhtunkhwa** and **Gilgit-Baltistan** highlights Pakistan's mountainous northern terrain as a passage for energy and trade.
- **Strategic Depth:** Enhances regional cooperation through geography and provides Pakistan with **clean, renewable energy** options.

CPEC (China-Pakistan Economic Corridor)

Major Projects of China-Pakistan Economic Corridor



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- A collection of infrastructure projects that form part of China's Belt and Road Initiative (BRI).
 - Runs from **Kashgar in China's Xinjiang province** to **Gwadar Port in Pakistan's Balochistan**.

A world map with a red rectangle in the center containing the text 'Thank You'. The map shows various countries and continents, including North America, South America, Europe, Africa, Asia, and Australia. The text 'Thank You' is written in a large, white, sans-serif font. The red rectangle is positioned in the center of the map, covering parts of North America, South America, and the Atlantic Ocean.

Thank You